

Replicating the Cost of Fear

The Cost of Fear study measured how foot traffic at small businesses changed after immigration enforcement actions in Los Angeles, and what that meant in lost sales. The method, the code, and a step-by-step guide are ready for other jurisdictions to use.

How much help you need depends on your data access and your team's capacity.

Start with a scoping call. Every engagement can start with a free 30–45 minute call. We talk through your study area, your data access, and who on your team can run the work. Then we recommend one of the options below.

	Option 1 You run it, we answer questions	Option 2 You run it, we help with the data	Option 3 We run it for you
Best for	Teams with an analyst who can run a Python notebook and a few reviewers.	Teams who can run scripts and review businesses, but have not worked with foot-traffic data.	Teams who want results without building the capacity in-house.
Your team does	• License the data • Build the enforcement event list • Run the pipeline • Review and classify businesses • Write it up	• License the data • Build the enforcement event list • Run the pipeline • Review and classify businesses • Write it up	• License the data • Build the enforcement event list • Answer local questions during business review • Supply local spend benchmarks
We do	• Answer questions by email • Up to three short calls • Point you to the right step in the guide	• Scope the data purchase and filters • Write the data plan for your study area • Set the cleaning and classification rules • Check your business review for errors • Troubleshoot the pipeline	• Everything from download through dollar estimates • Deliver results tables, charts, and the business-level data • Write a methods memo you can cite
Estimated hours	5 – 10	25 – 40	80 – 120
Estimated cost	\$1,000 – \$2,000	\$5,000 – \$8,000	\$16,000 – \$24,000

What you need in every option

- **Foot-traffic data.** Advan Weekly Patterns Plus, bought through Dewey Data. Your jurisdiction licenses it directly. Filter to your study area at download time.
- **An enforcement event list.** A street address and a date for each incident, from local news, legal aid groups, or public records.
- **Spend-per-visit benchmarks.** Industry averages for each type of business, adjusted to your local prices.

Rates are estimates at \$200 per hour. Final scope and cost are set after the scoping call. Options can be combined, and a jurisdiction can move between them.

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